# The Idea Basket

*Civic Skill: Voice & Participation | EYLF: EYLF Outcome 4 (Learning) & Outcome 2 (Community) | Duration: 20–30 minutes | Age: 4–6 years*

### LEARNING INTENTION

Children will contribute ideas about a genuine, upcoming decision using whichever mode suits them — drawing, dictation, photo, or object — practising that participation can take many valid forms (Mosaic methodology; 'adopt a range of approaches').

## SUCCESS CRITERIA

- I can add an idea to the basket in my own way.
- I can explain my idea to someone if I want to.
- I can look at other people's ideas with curiosity.

### MATERIALS

- A genuine, bounded decision to be made (e.g., what to name a new classroom plant, what to add to the reading corner)
- A decorated 'Idea Basket'
- Small blank idea cards, drawing materials, a camera or tablet for photo ideas
- Small loose parts or objects children can leave as symbolic ideas

## ACTIVITY STEPS

**1. INTRODUCE THE DECISION (3 min):** 'We need to decide ___. This time, everyone gets to add an idea in whatever way works best for you.'

**2. IDEA STATIONS (12 min):** Set up drawing, dictation (with educator scribe), and photo/object tables. Children move freely, contributing one or more ideas to the basket over the session.

**3. SHARING CIRCLE (8 min):** Pull ideas from the basket one at a time. Read, show, or describe each. Brief discussion after each: 'What do you notice about this idea?'

**4. CLOSING (2 min):** 'We now have lots of ways of thinking about this. Next time, we'll decide together.' Store the basket safely for the follow-up decision-making session.

| EXTENSIONS | ASSESSMENT |
| --- | --- |
| • Sort the ideas into categories together before the follow-up decision<br>• Pair this lesson with a class meeting (see existing 'Class Meeting' lesson) as a two-part sequence: gather, then decide<br>• Keep the Idea Basket as a permanent, always-available fixture in the room | • Note the range of modalities each child used across the session<br>• Observe children who contributed non-verbally — did their idea reach the group as effectively as a spoken one?<br>• Photograph and collate the basket's contents as a documentation artefact of the group's thinking |

## EDUCATOR REFLECTION QUESTIONS

- Which modality generated the richest or most surprising ideas?
- Were there children who didn't contribute at all? What might help them next time?
- How could the Idea Basket become a standing feature of decision-making in your room?

### EYLF LINKS

*This lesson directly supports EYLF Outcome 4 (Learning) & Outcome 2 (Community). Educators should record observations using anecdotal notes, photographs, or learning stories focused on children's language, body responses, and social interactions during the session.*